

EAGLE-EYED VIEW
Minister for Greater Bengaluru Development Krishna Byre Gowda in Bengaluru, Sept. 18

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the present city of 712 sq. km, making of it only the yolk of the egg.

It's the opposite of the Japanese KonMari technique, where a messy ensemble is reorganised in smaller, tidier spaces. Bengaluru city, which has far outgrown its load-bearing capacity in the past three boom decades, has gone beyond that stage. So instead, it will colonise the surrounding landscape—and be reborn as a well-planned network of five priority growth drivers spread over three districts. The plan is to reshape the Bengaluru Metropolitan Region (BMR) into a world-leading technology hub (see *Bengaluru 2037*). A second airport and other infrastructure projects are also part of the plan. This time, traffic will hopefully move—with the Metro and other public transport taking up 70 per cent of the load.

But movement is what the present city needs too—it cannot be left to its fate. This is where Byre Gowda strides into the frame like a catalytic force. One of the rarer breeds of politicians, combining articulacy with action, polish with unusual degrees of perseverance, he has since June taken charge of Greater Bengaluru, the new moniker for the space delimited by the present city. Charge is quite the right word. It's almost like a man possessed that he has gone at the portfolio ceded to him by D.K. Shivakumar (DKS) when he moved up to become chief minister. Mountains of garbage, teeming encroachments, jagged footpaths, potholes, flooding, tree plantations, stray dogs—none of the nightmares that bedevil Indian cities has escaped his disciplining eye. His mode blends seriousness about process, the classic technocratic turf, with a public-facing approach. So review meetings with officials go like a chief of staff corralling self-willed civic agencies into working under a unified command.

"The minister actually understands the problem and also identifies the bottlenecks. He is capable and goes into detail. He's also politically very savvy," says R.K. Misra, a member of